[Metric]
A-A-2758A
November 01, 1995
Superseding
A-A-2758
October 18th, 1991

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION
MARKER, TUBE TYPE, FELT TIP
(PERMANENT INK)

This General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description by all federal agencies.

1. Scope: This Commercial Item Description covers broad felt tip, permanent ink, tube type markers suitable for writing on porous and non-porous surfaces.

2. Salient Characteristics:

2.1 The marker shall be a non-refillable tube type designed to operate by capillary action. The marker shall be constructed so as to provide good protection against evaporation and leakage. Removal of the cap for up to fifteen hours (recuperation of 30 minutes) shall not affect the instruments marking ability.

2.2 The ink shall be held within the marker by an absorbent material so that there is no free liquid within the marker. The ink shall not smudge when allowed to dry for more than three seconds when marking on plain bond paper.

2.3 The marker shall be equipped with a tight-fitting plastic or metal protective cap and the over-all length (with the cap in place) shall not be less than 125 mm (4.9 inches) and no more than 175 mm (6.9 inches). The diameter shall be not less than 10 mm (.4 inches) and not more than 20 mm (.8 inches).

2.4 The markers shall be furnished in the following colors; Black, Blue, Red, Green, Brown, Orange, Purple, and Yellow as specified in the contract or order. Metal or plastic used shall be of a material appropriate for the intended purpose and when used externally shall be suitable for coating when used as a decorative finish.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Engineering Branch, 26 Federal Plaza, New York, NY 10278.

FSC 7520

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2.5 The marker barrel shall be made of plastic or metal or a combination of these materials, and constructed so that the ink will emerge only through the writing nib. The writing nib may be of any material suitable for the intended purpose. The nib shall be permanently secured in position.

2.6 The cap or body shall be colored, or have a colored marking to indicate the color of ink content. The minimum writing distance for these markers shall be 609 meters (2000 ft).

2.7 The manufacturer's name or trademark shall be exhibited on the marker. Placement of these permanent markings shall be at the option of the manufacturer, provided they are prominently displayed.

2.8 Shelf Life. The markers shall be able to meet all the requirements of this specification from the time of delivery to a minimum of 18 months in storage under normal storage conditions. Suppliers shall replace, without cost to the government, all markers failing to meet this requirement.

2.9 Workmanship. The markers shall be free from defects or imperfections of manufacture which may affect their durability, appearance, serviceability or present a hazard to the user. The surface of the marker shall be of uniform appearance and shall be free from rough, sharp edges, or burrs, blisters, scratches and other defects.

3. Regulatory Requirements:

The offerer/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable, in accordance with paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR).

4. Quality Assurance Requirements:

4.1 Contractor Certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and therefore as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

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4.2 Examination and Testing.

4.2.1 Suppliers are encouraged to use quality control (QC) techniques that exhibit control over their processes (e.g. (Statistical Process Control) SPC Techniques) as defined in American National Standards Institute (ANSI) Z1.1, Z1.2 and Z1.3 / American Society for Quality Control (ASQC) B.1, B.2 and B.3 that systematically reduce excess variations. If used, objective evidence shall be available that demonstrates overall measurement adequacy techniques and controls. These techniques shall ensure quality levels equal to, or greater than, those cited in applicable technical document or, herein.

4.2.2 End item inspection / testing may be used by the offeror or the Government representative, as a means to determine the effectiveness of the in process quality controls. In process controls shall not be substituted for end item performance testing.

4.2.3 For those characteristics for which there are no such controls, or for end item performance test, lot by lot sampling for inspection / test shall be required. The sample unit shall be one marker. Sampling shall be in accordance with the American National Standards Institute (ANSI) / American Society for Quality Control (ASQC) Z1.4, Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

4.2.4 An inspection lot shall consist of all like items submitted for inspection at one time. The inspection level for visual and dimensional testing shall be S-3 with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective. The inspection level for performance characteristics testing shall be S-1 with an AQL of 6.5 percent defective. The supplier must provide objective evidence (tests and inspection records) that the presented material meets the requirements of the sampling plan as indicated above.

4.3 **Performance Tests**: Unless otherwise specified, the tests shall be conducted in an atmosphere of 21° ± 3°C (64.5°-75.2°F) and a relative humidity of 50% ± 5%. Test paper shall be in accordance with A-A-2804A, type III white bond paper having a pH of 5.0 with a basis weight of 60 grams per square meter 7.6 kg (16 pound) 17 x 22 - 500. A tolerance of 5% is allowable. Paper for the Machine Writing Test shall have an additional requirement of 160 - 140 seconds maximum smoothness on both sides using the Sheffield method per the most current TAPPI T538 test method. Alternately, paper conforming to JCP-O-60 can be used as an alternate source.

4.3.1 Drying Time. Place a sheet of paper on a smooth, flat surface and partially cover with a second sheet of paper. Place a 115 gram weight 4.0 oz), approximately 31.75 mm (1.25 inches) in diameter, on top of the second sheet. Write a line on the exposed portion of the bottom sheet, allow to dry three seconds, and immediately draw the top sheet and the weight across the writing at a rate of approximately 101.6 mm (4.0 inches) per second. The writing shall not smear or smudge.

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4.3.2 Machine Write Test. The machine tests shall be conducted on a Anja W-10B, K&L machine broad tip marker tester, or equivalent, with parameters set according to the machine's specific testing procedures. Testing of the marker shall continue until the distance requirement is met or the marker fails to produce a solid continuous line.

5. Packaging:

5.1 Preservation, packing, and marking shall be specified in the contract or order.

6.1 Applicable Documents. Issues of the following documents, in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

6.1.1 Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry (TAPPI) T479 method may be obtained from TAPPI, Technology Park, P.O. Box 105113, Atlanta, Georgia, 30348-5113.

6.1.2 Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington. DC 20402.

6.1.3 Application for copies of (ANSI) Z1.1, Z1.2 and Z1.3 and (ASQC) B.1, B.2 and B.3 may be obtained from the American Society for Quality Control. PO Box 3005, 611 E. Wisconsin Avenue, Milwaukee, WI 53201-4606.

6.1.4 JCP Specifications may be obtained from Chief Paper Procurement Section, MMPP, US Government Printing Office, North Capital and H Street, NW, Washington DC 20401.

6.1.5 Federal Standards and Specifications may be obtained from the General Services Administration Specifications Section (3FBO-W) in Suite 8100 at 490 L'Enfant Plaza, SW Washington DC 20407.

6.2 Ordering Information. Purchaser should select the required options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents.

A. Title, number, and date of this commercial item description.
B. Purchasers shall specify the color of marker required.
C. Purchasers shall specify arrangement for inspection and inspection facilities, if other than specified.
D. Purchasers shall specify packaging, packing, and any special marking for shipment, if other than required
E. Purchasers shall specify identification marking, if other than required.
F. Purchasers shall specify if bar code marking is not required.
G. Purchasers should specify palletization, if required.

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6.3 National Stock Number Listing.

Marker, Tube-Type, Broad Tip

7520-00-079-0285
7520-00-079-0286
7520-00-079-0287
7520-00-079-0288
7520-00-973-1059
7520-00-973-1060
7520-00-973-1061
7520-00-973-1062
7520-00-230-2734

Marker, Tube-Type, Broad Tip (Assortment)

7520-00-558-1501

MILITARY INTERESTS:
NONE: DoD has determined that no military activity has an interest in this commercial item description.

PREPARING ACTIVITY
GSA-FSS

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